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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 1

Semester 1

Terms 1 and 2

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

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Notes

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 1 of two booklets (Terms 1 and 2). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 1 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 1 and 2, the other booklet follows Semester 2 (Terms 3 and 4). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it. On the Finish the Figure page the check tests whether the pupil can tell which printed half matches; look at the pupil's drawing at a glance.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes, and every box on it must follow the rule on the page.
- **Logic grid, queue, strips and matching pictures.** Each number, child, strip or picture has a letter; the letters, read in the order asked, must spell a word. Where one item is left out, its letter is a decoy that is not part of the word.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the total printed in the strip (the graph pages add a second sum).
- **Loop.** The numbers on touching tiles must match all the way round the loop.

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S1-02, S1-04) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way. Light crayons work best: a dark crayon hides the number in the part on a photocopy.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S1-12) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as comparing amounts and making them equal, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size); on the ruler pages a real ruler matches the drawn ruler only at 100%.

Pictures are not actual size.

Contents: Semester 1

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S1-01	P1-25	Count the Crowd	1 star
S1-02	P1-01	Colour the Rocket	1 star
S1-03	P1-24	Words and Numbers	1 star
S1-04	P1-12	Colour the House	1 star
S1-05	P1-19	Shape Count	1 star
S1-06	P1-07	The Queue	2 stars
S1-07	P1-08	Make Twelve	1 star
S1-08	P1-37	Bonds and Families	2 stars
S1-09	P1-10	Take Away Code	1 star
S1-10	P1-21	Story Sums	2 stars
S1-11	P1-09	Magic Square	2 stars
S1-12	P1-38	More or Fewer	2 stars
S1-13	P1-02	Mystery Numbers	2 stars
S1-14	P1-04	Sticker Grid	2 stars
S1-15	P1-26	Chart Patterns	2 stars
S1-16	P1-33	Shape Builder	2 stars
S1-17	P1-34	Finish the Figure	2 stars
S1-18	P1-31	Shortest to Longest	1 star
S1-19	P1-17	How Long?	1 star
S1-20	P1-13	Equal Groups	1 star

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P1-01 to P1-40).

What the booklet covers

Whole Numbers 1.1 counting to tell the number of objects in a given set **S1-01**

Whole Numbers 1.2 number notation, representations and place values (tens, ones) **S1-02, S1-13, S1-15**

Whole Numbers 1.3 reading and writing numbers in numerals and in words **S1-03**

Whole Numbers 1.4 comparing the number of objects in two or more sets **S1-01**

Whole Numbers 1.5 comparing and ordering numbers **S1-12, S1-13, S1-14, S1-15**

Whole Numbers 1.6 patterns in number sequences **S1-15**

Whole Numbers 1.7 ordinal numbers (first, second, up to tenth) and symbols (1st, 2nd, 3rd, etc.) **S1-03, S1-06**

Addition and Subtraction 2.1 concepts of addition and subtraction **S1-07, S1-08, S1-09, S1-10, S1-12**

Addition and Subtraction 2.2 use of +, - and = **S1-07, S1-08, S1-10**

Addition and Subtraction 2.3 relationship between addition and subtraction **S1-08, S1-09**

Addition and Subtraction 2.4 adding more than two 1-digit numbers **S1-11**

Addition and Subtraction 2.7 mental calculation involving addition and subtraction (within 20; 2-digit number and ones without renaming; 2-digit number and tens) **S1-07, S1-09, S1-10**

Multiplication and Division 3.1 concepts of multiplication and division **S1-20**

Multiplication and Division 3.2 use of x **S1-20**

Multiplication and Division 3.3 multiplying within 40 **S1-20**

Length 1.1 measuring length in centimetres **S1-19**

Length 1.2 use of abbreviation cm **S1-18, S1-19**

Length 1.3 comparing and ordering lengths in cm **S1-18**

2D Shapes 1.1 identifying, naming, describing and classifying 2D shapes (rectangle, square, triangle, circle, half circle, quarter circle) **S1-04, S1-05, S1-16**

2D Shapes 1.2 forming different 2D figures with rectangle, square, triangle, half circle, quarter circle **S1-16**

2D Shapes 1.3 identifying the 2D shapes that make up a given figure **S1-05, S1-16**

2D Shapes 1.4 copying figures on dot grid or square grid **S1-17**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Addition and Subtraction 2.5; Addition and Subtraction 2.6; Multiplication and Division 3.4; Money 1.1; Length 1.4; Time 2.1; Time 2.2; Time 2.3; Time 2.4; Picture Graphs 1.1.